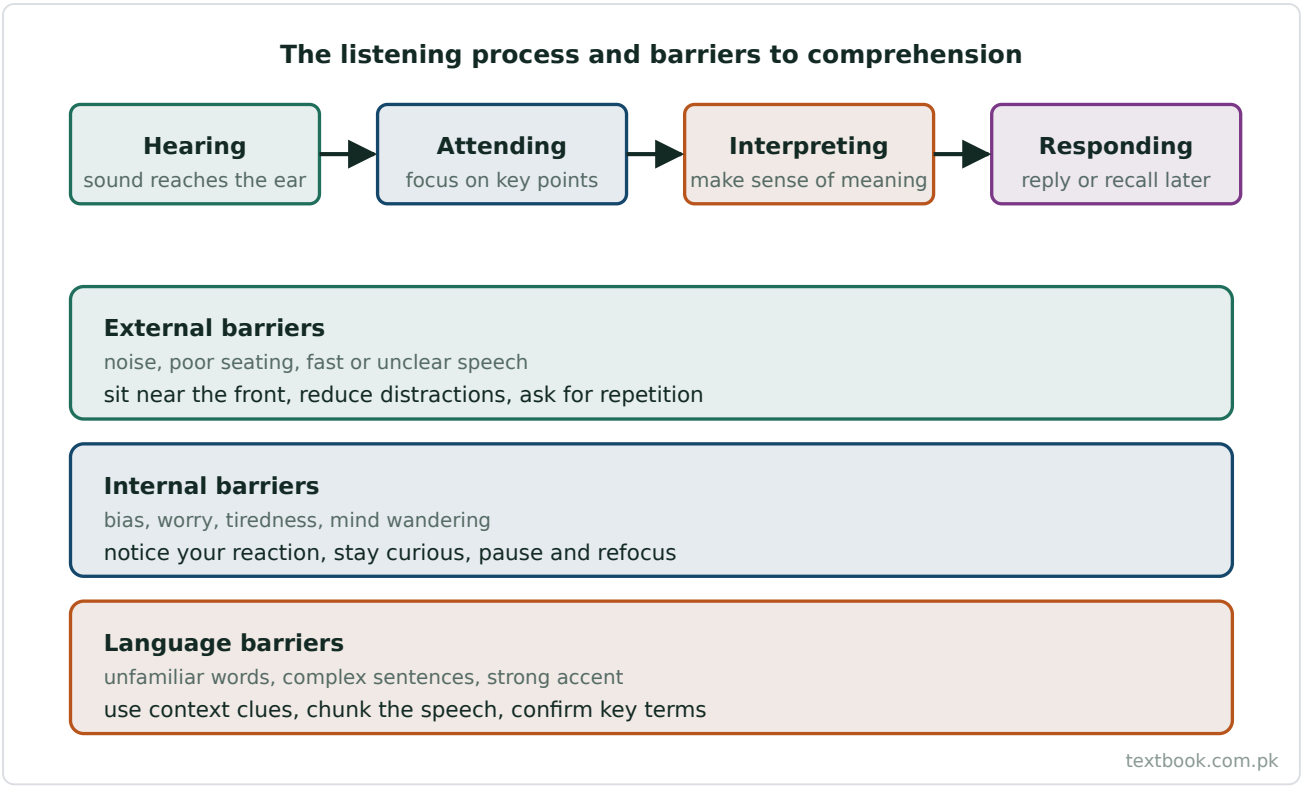
Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform’s automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Topic 2.3 - Critical reading and listening in practice

A real classroom situation



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Miss Hina teaches Class 9 English in a government school in Quetta. She reads her pupils a short news report about a local event and asks them what it says. The pupils can repeat the facts. She then asks them what the report assumes and what it leaves out. The pupils are silent. This topic is about moving from understanding a text to evaluating it.

Explanation

Topics 2.1 and 2.2 gave you the tools: purpose, audience, context, tone, bias, assumptions, inferences, reading strategies and listening strategies. This topic asks you to apply all of them to a complete text.

Analysing a complete text

Note-taking formats compared

Format	Description	When to use it
Linear notes	points written in the order you hear or read them, using headings and numbered lists	a clear, step-by-step lecture or textbook chapter
Mind map	a central idea with branches for linked ideas, keywords and images	brainstorming connections between topics
Cornell notes	a page split into cues, notes and a summary section at the bottom	reviewing and self-testing after a lesson

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When you analyse a complete text, work in four moves:

1. **Identify the surface features.** What is the purpose? Who is the audience? What is the context? What is the tone? These are the features Topic 2.1 described.

2. **Identify the hidden features.** What does the text assume? What can you infer? What biases or stereotypes are present? These are also from Topic 2.1, but they require deeper reading.

3. **Evaluate the strategies.** Did the writer make good choices for the purpose and audience? Is the structure effective? Is the evidence adequate? This is where you move from description to judgement.

4. **Connect to your own context.** Does this text work for a Pakistani classroom? Would you use it as it is, adapt it, or reject it? This is where you move from analysis to application.

The figure above maps the listening process and the barriers to comprehension. Use it when you analyse spoken texts (lectures, speeches, discussions) as well as written ones.

Critical listening in practice

Critical listening follows the same four moves. When you listen to a lecture, a speech or a discussion, you identify purpose, audience, context and tone; you identify assumptions, inferences and biases; you evaluate the speaker's choices; and you connect to your own context. The main difference is that spoken texts disappear as soon as they are spoken, which makes note-taking more important.

Common misconception. "Critical reading means finding faults." It does not. Critical reading means understanding how a text works and evaluating whether it works well for its purpose and audience. A text can be well-written and still be biased; a text can be flawed and still be useful.

Activity: Analyse a complete text

Work in groups of three. Take a short English text (a newspaper editorial, a textbook introduction, or a government pamphlet). Apply the four moves: identify surface features, identify hidden features, evaluate the strategies, connect to your Pakistani classroom context. Allow 30 minutes. Then present your analysis to another group and discuss.

Check your understanding

1. Describe the four moves for analysing a complete text, in order. *(Remember)*
2. A pupil says, "I understand the text but I do not know if it is good." Using this topic's account, explain what skill the pupil needs to develop. *(Analyze)*

3. Explain the difference between identifying a feature of a text and evaluating it, and give one example of each. *(Understand)*
4. A friend says, "Critical reading means finding faults with everything." Using this topic's account, explain what that claim overlooks. *(Evaluate)*
5. A text about healthy eating assumes that all readers have access to fresh fruit and vegetables. Identify the assumption and explain what it reveals about the intended audience. *(Analyze)*

Summary

Analysing a complete text means identifying surface features, identifying hidden features, evaluating the writer's choices and connecting to your own context. Critical listening follows the same four moves. Critical reading means understanding how a text works, not just finding faults.

Self-assessment checklist

Sign in to sync your ticks across devices.

- [ ] I can describe the four moves for analysing a complete text.
- [ ] I can apply all the skills from Topics 2.1 and 2.2 to a described text.
- [ ] I can distinguish between identifying a feature and evaluating it.
- [ ] I can analyse a spoken text using the same four moves as for a written text.
- [ ] I can explain what critical reading is and what it is not.

Try this at your practicum school

Take one English textbook passage used in the class you are observing. Apply the four moves: identify surface features, identify hidden features, evaluate the strategies, connect to the Pakistani classroom context. Write one page on your findings and recommend whether the passage should be used as it is, adapted or replaced.

Summative task

Write 400 to 450 words on the following.

> Read the following text: "Pakistan's literacy rate has improved significantly over the past decade, according to the latest government report. The report shows that enrolment in primary schools has increased by 15 percent, with the largest gains in urban areas. Education officials say the improvement is the result of increased government spending and better teacher training. However, independent analysts note that the data does not distinguish between enrolment and actual attendance, and that the literacy rate in rural areas remains well below the national average." Apply the four moves for analysing a complete text to this passage.

Mini-rubric

Criterion	What a strong response does
Identification of surface features (Understand)	Identifies purpose, audience, context and tone with evidence
Identification of hidden features (Analyze)	Identifies assumptions, inferences or biases with evidence
Evaluation of the writer's choices (Evaluate)	**Moves beyond description to judge whether the text works for its purpose and audience**
Register and clarity	Writes for a colleague, defines any technical term used, stays within the word count

Further reading

- Kintsch, W. *Comprehension: A Paradigm for Cognition.* (guide recommended)
- James, M., & Merickel, A. P. *Reading Literature and Writing Argument.* (guide recommended)
- Johns, J., & Lenski, S. *Improving Reading: Strategies, Resources, and Common Core Connections.* (guide recommended)

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

Give feedback